

YUJIN ZHANG

Contact Information

Department of Political Science
Columbia University
420 W. 118th Street
New York, NY, 10027

@ yz3658@columbia.edu
Website: yujinzhang.com

Education

Columbia University in the City of New York, New York, NY 2027 (Expected)

Ph.D., Political Science

– Fields: International Relations (Major), Comparative Politics

– Dissertation: Early-Life Experiences and Global Public Opinion on Economic Policymaking

– Dissertation Committee: Allison Carnegie (Co-Chair), Nikhar Gaikwad (Co-Chair), Junyan Jiang, Calvin Thrall

M.Phil., Political Science

2022

M.A., Political Science

2020

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University, Washington, D.C.

2018

M.A., International Political Economy and International Economics

Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO

2016

B.A., magna cum laude, Business Administration

Hunan University, Changsha, Hunan, China

2014

B.A., Finance

Research Interests

Research Focus: International political economy, transformation of the international economic order, economic security and statecraft, political socialization

Regional Focus: East Asia, Developed Economies

Publications

[2] **Zhang, Yujin.** 2026. "Inflation of Populism: Effects of Early Economic Experiences on Support for Populist Parties." *Economics & Politics*, Early View.

– Keywords: Inflation, Populism, Early Experiences, Public Opinion, European Politics

[1] Ji, Chengyuan, Junyan Jiang, and **Yujin Zhang.** 2024. "Political Trust and Government Performance in the Time of COVID-19." *World Development* 176 (106499).

– Keywords: Health governance, political trust

Revise & Resubmit

[2] **Zhang, Yujin.** "Assistance to Me, and to Thee: Early Inequality Experiences and Public Preferences for Overseas Aid." *Revise and Resubmit at International Studies Quarterly*. [Link](#).

– Keywords: Foreign Aid, Inequality, Early Experiences, Public Opinion, Developed Countries

[1] **Zhang, Yujin.** "Prosperity and Openness: Early Globalization Experiences and Mass Preferences for Free Trade." *Revise and Resubmit at Comparative Political Studies*. (Job Market Paper). [Link](#).

– Keywords: Trade preferences, Formative Experiences, Public Opinion, East and South-east Asia

– Presentations: APSA 2024, MPSA 2024

Under Review	[2] Zhang, Yujin and Ziwen Zu. “Rethinking Backlash against Trade Openness: Import-Export Preferences in Two Dimensions.” Link. – Previous Title: “Why Mercantilism? Preferences for Trade Surplus and Mercantilist Policies” – Keywords: Globalization Backlash, Mercantilism, Isolationism, Survey Experiment, United States and China – Presentations: APSA 2026, GSIPE-APSA 2026, ISA 2026, IPES 2025 [1] Zhang, Yujin and Ziwen Zu. “Collaborative Competition? The Efficiency-Risk Dilemma and Public Preferences for International Technological Transfer.” Link. – Keywords: Technological preferences; Economic Security; Geopolitical Competition; the United States; Survey experiment – Presentations: APSA 2026, ISA 2026, IPES 2025
Working Papers	[2] Zhang, Yujin. “Partisan Responses to Economic Shocks: Inflation Crises and the Paradox of Trade Liberalization.” Link. – Keywords: Inflation crisis, trade liberalization, political parties, electoral politics – Presentations: APSA 2025, MPSA 2025 [1] Zhang, Yujin. “Aversion to What?: Early-Life Economic Experiences and Responses to Inflation.” Link. – Keywords: Formative experiences, macroeconomic attitudes, Europe – Presentations: APSA 2023
Research In Progress	[4] “International Cooperation between Nationalists.” [3] “Support for Industrial Policies.” [2] “Environmental and Electoral Consequences of the Trade War.” [1] “Life Experiences and Attitudes toward Military Alliance.” with Allison Carnegie and Elizabeth Saunders.
Policy Publication	[1] 2018. “China’s Coal-to-Gas Program: A Developing Environmental Governance Regime.” <i>SAIS Review of International Affairs</i>. Link.
Teaching Interests & Experience	IPE, globalization, economic security, politics of technology, Chinese politics, research design and survey methods Columbia University Politics of International Economic Relations, Prof. Jeffry Frieden Fall 2024 Chinese Politics, Prof. Junyan Jiang Fall 2021, Spring 2023 China’s Foreign Relations, Prof. Thomas Christensen Spring 2021, Fall 2022, Spring 2025 International Politics, Prof. Alexander de la Paz Spring 2022 Autocracy and Democracy, Prof. Timothy Frye Fall 2020 SAIS, Johns Hopkins University Advanced Topics in International Trade (Graduate), Prof. Hiau Looi Kee Spring 2018

Research Assistance	Columbia University	
	Prof. Nikhar Gaikwad	2022-25
	Prof. Junyan Jiang	2021-23, 25
	SAIS, Johns Hopkins University	
	Prof. Ling Chen	2017-19
	Prof. David Steinberg	2018-19
Fellowships, Grants, and Awards	External	
	Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies (\$6,500)	2024, 26
	Finalist, NY/PANJ AAPOR Young Public Opinion Stars	2024, 26
	Expense Support Grant, Institute for Humane Studies (\$7,500)	2025
	Travel Grant, Graduate Students in International Political Economy	2022
	Travel Grant, International Studies Association	2019
	Columbia University	
	C. Martin Wilbur Fellowship	2025-26
	CPE Graduate Student Grant (\$7,000)	2025-26
	Dissertation Fellowship	2023-24
	Travel Grant	2023-26
	Teaching Fellowship	2020-23, 24
	Weatherhead East Asian Institute Fellowship	2019-20
	SAIS, Johns Hopkins University	
	SAIS Fellowship	2017-18
Conferences & Workshops	2026: APSA $c,d \times 3, p \times 2$ $\diamond$ GSIPE-APSA Pre-Conference Workshop $\diamond$ ISA $c, p \times 2$ $\diamond$ IHS Trade Workshop	
	2025: IPES $p \times 2$ $\diamond$ GSIPE d, p $\diamond$ MPSA d, p	
	2024: Virtual International Political Economy Society $\diamond$ NY/PANJ AAPOR Young Public Opinion Stars $\diamond$ GSIPE Mini-Conference $\diamond$ GSIPE d, p $\diamond$ APSA $\diamond$ MPSA	
	2023: Northeast Regional Workshop in European Politics $\diamond$ GSIPE d, p $\diamond$ APSA	
	2022: GSIPE APSA Workshop	
	2021: Political Science Speaker Series	
	2019: ISA	
	2018: MPSA	
	<i>*c = Chair, d = Discussant, p = Paper</i>	
Skills	Languages: Mandarin (Native)	
	Programming: R, Stata, L ^A T _E X, Python, LLM API integration	
	Methods: Survey design, experiment design, conjoint analysis	
Service	Event Coordinator, Graduate Students in International Political Economy	2024-25
Referee	<i>Policy Studies Social Science Research World Development</i>	

Professional Experience	The US-China Business Council	2018-19
	China Africa Research Initiative	2016-17, 2018-19
	The Woodrow Wilson International Center for Scholars	2018
	The Brookings Institution	2018
References	Allison Carnegie Department of Political Science Columbia University 1331 International Affairs 420 W. 118th Street New York, NY 10027 allison.carnegie@columbia.edu	Nikhar Gaikwad Department of Political Science Columbia University 739 International Affairs 420 W. 118th Street New York, NY 10027 nikhar.gaikwad@columbia.edu
	Junyan Jiang Department of Political Science Columbia University 917 International Affairs 420 W. 118th Street New York, NY 10027 jj3160@columbia.edu	Calvin Thrall Department of Political Science Columbia University 734 International Affairs 420 W. 118th Street New York, NY 10027 ct3168@columbia.edu